

Η ΝΕΚΡΩΣΙΜΟΣ ΑΚΟΛΟΥΘΙΑ



THE ORTHODOX FUNERAL SERVICE

Sources

Petitions

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Approved Text from Ecumenical Patriarchate of Constantinople:
Protocol Number 975 dated October 30, 2014.

Creed and Lord's Prayer

Official Translation of the Lord's Prayer and the Confession of Faith as adopted by the Holy Eparchial Synod of the Greek Orthodox Archdiocese of America, 2004.

Scripture

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Greek Text

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Approved Text from Ecumenical Patriarchate of Constantinople:
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Christ is Risen

The text and music of "Christ is Risen" is the version produced and adopted by the Holy Eparchial Synod of the Greek Orthodox Archdiocese of America: Protocol Number 43/12 dated March 21, 2012.

With the blessings of His Eminence Metropolitan Alexios of Atlanta

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The Funeral Service of the Orthodox Church

God's mercy is infinite and His goodness is beyond measure. This is what our Holy Church has always maintained, and thus believes and hopes that the loving Lord will be merciful even to the deceased. For this reason the hymnographers of the Orthodox Church have composed a most moving funeral service that is virtually a treasure-house of profound spiritual thoughts.

From the earliest Christian times, psalms and hymns were sung to our life-creating God when a believer died. But the basic parts of the funeral service in use today can be traced mainly to the fifth century. With the passage of time, the service has been enriched with psalms and hymns so that it has become one of the most dramatic and impassionate services of our Church.

The funeral service of the Orthodox Church is an example of how Orthodox theology influences the formation of a healthy understanding of the true nature of life and death. The service accomplishes the following: a) utilizes the occasion of death to help us develop a more profound understanding of the meaning and purpose of life; b) helps us to deal with the emotions we have at the time of death and as time passes after the death; c) emphasizes the fact that death for the Christian is not the end, and affirms our hope in salvation and eternal life; d) recognizes the existence of the emotions of grief caused by the separation from a loved one, and encourages their expression.

In the readings, prayers and hymns of the funeral service a dramatic dialogue takes place between the faithful and God and the deceased and God. The service acknowledges the reality of human existence—the frailty of life and the vanity of worldly things—and directs our minds and hearts to contemplate the incomparable value of the eternal blessings of God's Kingdom. At the same time with a contrite spirit, the Priests and people invoke the infinite mercy of the Almighty God for the departed.

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Anyone who attentively follows the hymns and prayers of the funeral service will be edified and consoled in many ways. The service is not only an opportunity to express our love for our loved one who has fallen asleep, it is also a sacred time, a marvelous opportunity for reflection and inner meditation on our own relationship with God and on the orientation of our lives. When we reflect on the sublime thoughts of the funeral service our souls become contrite, our hearts are softened, and we pray fervently for the forgiveness and the repose of the person who has been transferred to the life beyond the grave. Also, we who are still alive are beckoned to live the rest of our lives in repentance and in full dedication to Christ.

Saint John Chrysostom beautifully observes:

“The Jews of the Old Testament wept for Jacob and for Moses for forty days. Today, however, during the funeral of the faithful, the Church raises hymns and prayers and psalms. We glorify and thank God, because “He crowned the departing,” because “He relieved the pains,” because “He expelled the fear,” and has the deceased believer near Him. This is why the hymns and psalms reveal that in the event of death there is pleasure and joy following the glorious Resurrection of the Savior Jesus Christ. For the psalms and hymns are symbols of joy, according to the Apostolic word: “Is any cheerful? Let him sing praises (James 5:13).” This is why we sing psalms over the dead—psalms which move us to have courage and not to despair over the death of our brother.”

Order of the Funeral Service

The funeral service of the Orthodox Church consists of hymns, prayers and readings from the Scriptures. The order of the service is as follows:

- The Trisagion Service chanted at the funeral home or in the Church on the evening before the funeral service and on the day of the funeral, at the graveside following the funeral service, and for memorial services.

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- Selection of verses from Psalm 118 (119), in three stanzas: (Part I -verses 1, 20, 28, 36, 53, 63; Part II -verses 73, 83, 94, 102, 112, 126; Part III -verses 132, 141, 149, 161 1 175, 176).
- Blessings (Evlogetaria): *"Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments."* (Psalm 118 [119]:12)
- Funeral Hymns by St. John of Damascus in the Eight Modes.
- Scripture Readings: (a) 1 Thessalonians 4:13-17 and (b) John 5:24-30.
- Small Litany, prayers and Dismissal.
- The Kiss of Peace and the anointing of the body.
- The chanting of the Trisagion Service at the cemetery.

Trisagion Service: Before the Funeral Service itself, the brief Trisagion or "Thrice-Holy" Service is served at the place where the deceased lies. This service derives its name because it begins with the familiar prayer, *"Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us,"* repeated three times. After the initial prayers, four hymns are chanted asking the Lord to give rest to the deceased among those who have already been perfected in the faith. A litany follows and is concluded with a prayer that includes again the petition to the Lord to grant rest to the deceased and asks for the forgiveness of sins. Before the service is concluded, the faithful sing, *"May your memory be eternal."*

Psalm 118 (119): The funeral service begins with the chanting in three stanzas of verses from Psalm 118 (119). In Greek this is referred to as the Amomos (blameless) because the first words are, *"Blameless in the way."* Following the first stanza, a Small Litany is said with petitions for the departed. If more than one Priest is officiating, this litany is said after each stanza.

Evlogetaria: Following the chanting of Psalm 118 (119) are the Funeral Praises, the Evlogetaria. These hymns are chanted in a solemn tone which highlights their deep theological content. They are called "Evlogetaria" (meaning hymns of praise) because each

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one is preceded by Psalm 119:12, *"Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments."*

Funeral Hymns by St. John of Damascus in the Eight Modes: At the conclusion of the Evlogetaria, the Kontakion of the Funeral Service is chanted: *"With all the saints give rest, O Christ, to the soul of Your servant, where there is no pain, no sorrow, and no sighing, but life everlasting."*

During the chanting of this hymn, the Priest censes the deceased and the faithful, as well as the Holy Altar Table and icons. Following this are chanted the very moving hymns, each in its own particular melody, and are sung in the order of the eight modes of Byzantine chant. These hymns and their changing melodic modes express the mixed emotions of grief and consolation that come from the loss of a loved one and in our affirmation of our hope in God's promise of rest for the departed and eternal life.

Scripture Readings: The funeral service also includes two Scripture lessons, one from St. Paul's First Epistle to the Thessalonians 4:13-17 and from the Gospel according to Saint John 5:24-30. All of these passages reflect the Church's belief in the reality of Christ's death and Resurrection and of the benefits that we derive from them, namely, the resurrection of our body on the last day, and the promise of incorruption and immortality.

Prayers and Dismissal: Following the readings, the Small Litany that was said earlier is repeated, and the Priest offers a prayer for the repose of the deceased. The Priest, addressing Christ Who defeated death, asks the *"God of spirits and of all flesh"* to grant rest to the soul of the deceased *"in a place of light, a place of green pasture a place of refreshment...."* The dismissal prayer of the Funeral Service once again introduces the hope of the resurrection as the Priest calls upon the intercessions of the all-holy Theotokos, the holy Apostles, the holy Fathers, the three Patriarchs Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, and of the holy and righteous Lazarus, the friend

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of Christ who was raised from the dead by our Lord. After this prayer the faithful sing, *"May your memory be eternal."*

The Final Kiss and Anointing: Following the dismissal prayer comes the moment of our final farewell greeting to the deceased. As the people come forward to look upon the deceased, the choir or chanters sing hymns that invite them to offer a kiss to the one who has reposed in the faith while they pray for the Lord to give the person rest. The kiss given to the deceased is an expression of love for the departed, but it is also an affirmation that the one who has fallen asleep is worthy of the fulfillment of God's promises, having lived a life of faith and known the grace of God.

After the people and the family have come and offered their final greeting, the Priest anoints the body in the Sign of the Cross with oil and earth. As the Priest anoints with the oil he says: *"Sprinkle me with hyssop and I shall be clean. Wash me and I shall be whiter than snow (Psalm 50:7)."* As the Priest anoints the body with earth, he says: *"The Earth is the Lord's, and the fullness thereof; the world and all that dwell therein (Psalm 23:1). You are earth and to earth you shall return (Genesis 3:19)."*

At the Cemetery: Following the Funeral Service, the Priest and people proceed to the cemetery. Here, the Priest chants the Trisagion and the body is committed to the grave to await the return of our Lord and the resurrection of the dead.

Memorial Services: Forty days after the funeral, a memorial service is held at the end of the Divine Liturgy asking God to grant rest and save the soul of the departed person. Some of the same hymns and prayers which were read before the Funeral Service and at the cemetery are used in this service. Memorial services are also held approximately six months after the death of a person and after one year. It is also a custom of some to hold memorial services annually on the anniversary of the repose in the faith of their loved one.

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Κατά τὴν ἀρχαίαν τάξιν ὁ Ἱερεὺς φέρων Ἐπιτραχήλιον καὶ Φελώνιον καὶ κρατῶν θυμιατόν καὶ τὸν Σταυρόν εὐλογίας, συνώδευε τὴν ἐκφορὰν τοῦ νεκροῦ ἐκ τῆς οἰκίας εἰς τὸν Ναόν. Ἡ τάξις αὕτη διατηρεῖται μερικῶς σήμερον, καθὼς ὁ Ἱερεὺς συνοδεύει τὸ φέρετρον ἐκ τοῦ Νάρθηκος εἰς τὸν Σολέα, ἐνῶ ψάλλεται ἀργῶς τὸ «Ἅγιος ὁ Θεός,» καὶ οὕτω ἄρχεται ἡ Ἀκολουθία.

Κατὰ δὲ τὴν Πασχάλιον Περίοδον ἀντὶ τοῦ «Ἅγιος ὁ Θεός» ψάλλεται τὸ «Χριστὸς Ἀνέστη.»

Ὁ Λαὸς ἐγείρεται ἐκ τῶν καθισμάτων.

Διάκονος: Εὐλόγησον, δέσποτα.

Ἱερεὺς: Εὐλογητὸς ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, πάντοτε, νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Κατὰ τὴν Πασχάλιον περίοδον λέγομεν τό·

Χριστὸς ἀνέστη ἐκ νεκρῶν, θανάτῳ θάνατον πατήσας, καὶ τοῖς ἐν τοῖς μνήμασι ζωὴν χαρισάμενος. (γ')

Ψαλμός ριη' (118)

Στάσις Α'

Ἦχος πλ. β'.

1. Ἄνωμοι ἐν ὁδῷ. Ἀλληλούια.

Εὐλογητὸς εἶ, Κύριε, δίδαξόν με τὰ δικαιώματά σου. Ἀλληλούια.

2. Ἐπεπόθησεν ἡ ψυχὴ μου τοῦ ἐπιθυμῆσαι τὰ κρίματά σου ἐν παντὶ καιρῷ. Ἀλληλούια.

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During the ancient order the Priest, wearing his Epitrahilion (Stole) and Phelonion, taking the censer and the blessing Cross would escort the body from the family home to the Church. This practice is not done today, however, the Priest does meet the body in the Narthex and escorts it to the Solea while chanting the long "Holy God" until the start of the service.

During the Easter period, instead of chanting "Holy God" the People chant "Christ is risen."

The Faithful stand from their seats.

Deacon: Master, give the blessing.

Priest: Blessed is our God always, now and forever, and to the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

During the duration of the Easter period, we say:

Christ is risen from the dead, by death trampling down upon death, and to those in the tombs He has granted life. (3)

Psalm 118 (119)

First Stanza

Mode pl. 2.

1. Blameless is the way. Alleluia.

Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments.
Alleluia.

2. My soul is now burning with a strong desire for Your judgments at all times. Alleluia.

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3. Ἐνύσταξεν ἡ ψυχὴ μου ἀπὸ ἀκηδίας, βεβαίωσόν με ἐν τοῖς λόγοις σου. Ἀλληλούια.

4. Κλῖνον τὴν καρδίαν μου εἰς τὰ μαρτύριά σου, καὶ μὴ εἰς πλεονεξίαν. Ἀλληλούια.

5. Ἀθυμία κατέσχε με ἀπὸ ἀμαρτωλῶν, τῶν ἐγκαταλιμπανόντων τὸν νόμον σου. Ἀλληλούια.

6. Μέτοχος ἐγὼ εἰμι πάντων τῶν φοβουμένων σε, καὶ τῶν φυλασσόντων τὰς ἐντολάς σου. Ἀλληλούια.

Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἀγίῳ Πνεύματι. Καὶ νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν. Ἀλληλούια.

Ἡ Δέησις

Διάκονος: Ἐλέησον ἡμᾶς ὁ Θεός, κατὰ τὸ μέγα ἔλεός σου, δεόμεθά σου, ἐπάκουσον καὶ ἐλέησον.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον. (γ')

Διάκονος: Ἐτι δεόμεθα ὑπὲρ ἀναπαύσεως τῆς ψυχῆς τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου **(τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης)** τοῦ Θεοῦ **(δεῖνα)**, καὶ ὑπὲρ τοῦ συγχωρηθῆναι αὐτῷ **(αὐτῇ)** πᾶν πλημμέλημα ἐκούσιόν τε καὶ ἀκούσιον.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον. (γ')

Διάκονος: Ὅπως Κύριος ὁ Θεὸς τάξη τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** ἔνθα οἱ δίκαιοι ἀναπαύονται, τὰ ἐλέη τοῦ Θεοῦ, τὴν βασιλείαν τῶν οὐρανῶν καὶ ἄφεσιν τῶν αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** ἀμαρτιῶν, παρὰ Χριστῷ τῷ ἀθανάτῳ Βασιλεῖ καὶ Θεῷ ἡμῶν αἰτησώμεθα.

Λαός: Παρασχού, Κύριε.

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

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3. My soul has grown weary from sorrow; strengthen me with Your words. Alleluia.

4. Incline my heart to Your testimonies and not to greediness. Alleluia.

5. Despair took hold on me because of the sinners that forsake Your law. Alleluia.

6. I am a companion of all who fear You and keep Your commandments. Alleluia.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Now and forever, and to the ages of ages. Amen. Alleluia.

The Litany

Deacon: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Your great mercy, we pray to You, hear us and have mercy.

People: Lord, have mercy. (3)

Deacon: Again we pray for the repose of the soul of the departed servant of God (*name*), who has fallen asleep, and for the forgiveness of all his (**her**) sins, both voluntary and involuntary.

People: Lord, have mercy. (3)

Deacon: May the Lord God grant his (**her**) soul rest where the righteous repose, let us ask for the mercies of God, the Kingdom of Heaven and the forgiveness of his (**her**) sins, from Christ our immortal King and God.

People: Grant this, O Lord.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Καὶ ἐκφωνεῖ·

Ἱερεὺς: Ὅτι σὺ εἶ ἡ ἀνάστασις, ἡ ζωή, καὶ ἡ ἀνάπαυσις τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου (**τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης**) σου (**δεῖνα**), Χριστὲ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, καὶ σοὶ τὴν δόξαν ἀναπέμπομεν, σὺν τῷ ἀνάρχῳ σου Πατρὶ, καὶ τῷ παναγίῳ καὶ ἀγαθῷ καὶ ζωοποιῷ σου Πνεύματι, νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Ὁ Λαὸς κάθεται.

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Στάσις Β'

Ἦχος πλ. α'.

1. Αἱ χεῖρές σου ἐποίησάν με καὶ ἔπλασάν με, συνέτισόν με καὶ μαθήσομαι τὰς ἐντολάς σου. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε.

2. Ὅτι ἐγενήθην ὡς ἄσκος ἐν πάχνῃ, τὰ δικαιώματά σου οὐκ ἐπελαθόμην. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε.

3. Σὸς εἰμι ἐγώ, σῶσόν με, ὅτι τὰ δικαιώματά σου ἐξεζήτησα. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε.

4. Ἀπὸ τῶν κριμάτων σου οὐκ ἐξέκλινα, ὅτι σὺ ἐνομοθέτησάς με. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε.

5. Ἐκλίνα τὴν καρδίαν μου, τοῦ ποιῆσαι τὰ δικαιώματά σου εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα δι' ἀντάμειψιν. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε.

6. Καιρὸς τοῦ ποιῆσαι τῷ Κυρίῳ, διεσκέδασαν τὸν νόμον σου. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε.

Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἁγίῳ Πνεύματι. Καὶ νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν. Ἐλέησόν με, Κύριε, Κύριε.

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And he exclaims:

Priest: For You are the Resurrection, the Life and the Repose of Your departed servant *(name)*, who has fallen asleep, O Christ our God, and to You we offer up glory, with Your eternal Father Who is without beginning and Your all-holy, good and life-creating Spirit, now and forever, and to the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

The Faithful Sit.

Psalm 118 (119)

Second Stanza

Mode pl. 1.

1. Your hands have made me and fashioned me; instruct me, and I will learn Your commandments. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

2. I am like a wineskin in a frost; I did not forget Your commandments. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

3. I am Yours; save me, for I search Your commandments. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

4. I did not turn away from Your judgments, for You taught me Your law. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

5. I inclined my heart to perform Your commandments forever in return for Your mercies. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

6. It is time for the Lord to act; for they have transgressed Your law. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit. Now and forever, and to the ages of ages. Amen. Have mercy on me, O Lord.

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Ἐάν δέ παρίσταται καί δεύτερος Τερεύς, λέγει τήν κάτωθι αἴτησιν. Εἰ δέ μή, ἡ αἴτησις ταύτη παραλείπεται.

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

Τερεύς: Ὅτι σὺ εἶ ἡ ἀνάστασις, ἡ ζωή, καὶ ἡ ἀνάπαυσις τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου (**τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης**) σου (**δεῖνα**), Χριστὲ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, καὶ σοὶ τὴν δόξαν ἀναπέμπομεν, σὺν τῷ ἀνάρχῳ σου Πατρὶ, καὶ τῷ παναγίῳ καὶ ἀγαθῷ καὶ ζωοποιῷ σου Πνεύματι, νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

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Στάσις Γ'

Ἦχος πλ. δ'.

1. Καὶ ἐλέησόν με. Ἀλληλούια.

Ἐπίβλεψον ἐπ' ἐμὲ καὶ ἐλέησόν με, κατὰ τὸ κρῖμα τῶν ἀγαπώντων τὸ ὄνομά σου. Ἀλληλούια.

2. Νεώτερος ἐγὼ εἰμι, καὶ ἐξουδενωμένος, τὰ δικαιώματά σου οὐκ ἐπελαθόμην. Ἀλληλούια.

3. Τῆς φωνῆς μου ἄκουσον, Κύριε, κατὰ τὸ ἔλεός σου, κατὰ τὸ κρῖμα σου ζήσόν με. Ἀλληλούια.

4. Ἀρχοντες κατεδίωξάν με δωρεάν, καὶ ἀπὸ τῶν λόγων σου ἐδειλίασεν ἡ καρδιά μου. Ἀλληλούια.

5. Ζήσεται ἡ ψυχὴ μου καὶ αἰνέσει σε, καὶ τὰ κρίματά σου βοηθήσει μοι. Ἀλληλούια.

6. Ἐπλανήθην ὡς πρόβατον ἀπολωλός, ζήτησον τὸν δούλόν (**τὴν δούλην**) σου, ὅτι τὰς ἐντολάς σου οὐκ ἐπελαθόμην.

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If there is a second Priest present, he says the following petition. If there is not, then the litany is skipped.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Priest: For You are the Resurrection, the Life and the Repose of Your departed servant (*name*), who has fallen asleep, O Christ our God, and to You we offer up glory, with Your eternal Father Who is without beginning and Your all-holy, good and life-creating Spirit, now and forever, and to the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

Psalm 118 (119)

Third Stanza

Mode pl. 4.

1. And have mercy on me. Alleluia.

Look upon me and have mercy on me, according to the judgment of those who love Your Name. Alleluia.

2. I am young, and beheld as nothing, but I have not forgotten Your commandments. Alleluia.

3. Hear my voice, O Lord, according to Your mercy; give me life according to Your judgment. Alleluia.

4. Rulers persecuted me without cause, but my heart feared because of Your words. Alleluia.

5. My soul shall live and praise You, and Your judgments shall help me. Alleluia.

6. I went astray like a lost sheep; seek Your servant, for I have not forgotten Your commandments.

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Ἐάν δέ παρίσταται καί τρίτος Τερεύς, τότε οὗτος λέγει τήν κάτωθι αἴτησιν·

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

Τερεύς: Ὅτι σὺ εἶ ἡ ἀνάστασις, ἡ ζωή, καὶ ἡ ἀνάπαυσις τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου (**τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης**) σου (**δεῖνα**), Χριστέ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, καὶ σοὶ τὴν δόξαν ἀναπέμπομεν, σὺν τῷ ἀνάρχῳ σου Πατρί, καὶ τῷ παναγίῳ καὶ ἀγαθῷ καὶ ζωοποιῷ σου Πνεύματι, νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Τὰ Εὐλογητάρια Ἦχος πλ. α'.

Στιῆχ. Εὐλογητὸς εἶ, Κύριε, δίδαξόν με τὰ δικαιώματά σου.

Τῶν Ἀγίων ὁ χορὸς, εὗρε πηγὴν τῆς ζωῆς καὶ θύραν Παραδείσου, εὗρω καγώ, τὴν ὁδὸν διὰ τῆς μετανοίας, τὸ ἀπολωλὸς πρόβατον ἐγὼ εἰμι, ἀνακάλεσαί με, Σωτὴρ, καὶ σῶσόν με.

Ἐάν παρενρίσκωνται περισσότεροι τῶν τριῶν Τερέων, τότε, εἰς τὸ τέλος ἐκάστου τροπαρίου οἱ Τερεῖς ἐκφωνοῦν κατὰ σειρὰν τῶν πρεσβειῶν τὴν δέησιν «Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν» καὶ καταλήγουν μέ τὴν δοξολογικὴν ἐκφώνησιν «Ὅτι σὺ εἶ ἡ ἀνάστασις...»

The Funeral Service

If there is a third Priest present, then he says the following petition:

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Priest: For You are the Resurrection, the Life and the Repose of Your departed servant (*name*), who has fallen asleep, O Christ our God, and to You we offer up glory, with Your eternal Father Who is without beginning and Your all-holy, good and life-creating Spirit, now and forever, and to the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

The Evlogetaria Mode pl. 1.

Verse: *Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments.*

The choir of saints has found the Fountain of life and the Door of Paradise. May I also find the way through repentance. I am the lost sheep: O Savior, call me back and save me.

If there are more than three Priests, at the end of each Troparion the Deacon or one of the Priests says: "Let us pray to the Lord." The others, in order of seniority, say: "For You are the Resurrection..." i.e., we have as many exclamations as we have Priests.

Στίχ. Εὐλογητὸς εἶ, Κύριε, δίδαξόν με τὰ δικαιώματά σου.

Ὁ πάλαι μέν, ἐκ μὴ ὄντων πλάσας με, καὶ εἰκόνι σου θείᾳ τιμήσας, παραβάσει ἐντολῆς δὲ πάλιν μὲ ἐπιστρέψας εἰς γῆν ἐξ ἧς ἐλήφθην, εἰς τὸ καθ' ὁμοίωσιν ἐπανάγαγε, τὸ ἀρχαῖον κάλλος ἀναμορφώσασθαι.

Στίχ. Εὐλογητὸς εἶ, Κύριε, δίδαξόν με τὰ δικαιώματά σου.

Εἰκὼν εἰμι, τῆς ἀρρήτου δόξης σου, εἰ καὶ στίγματα φέρω πταισμάτων, οἰκτείρησον τὸ σὸν πλᾶσμα, Δέσποτα, καὶ καθάρισον σῇ εὐσπλαγχνίᾳ, καὶ τὴν ποθεινὴν πατρίδα παράσχου μοι. Παραδείσου πάλιν ποιῶν πολίτην με.

Στίχ. Εὐλογητὸς εἶ, Κύριε, δίδαξόν με τὰ δικαιώματά σου.

Ἀνάπαυσον, ὁ Θεὸς τὸν δουλόν **(τὴν δούλῃν)** σου, καὶ κατάταξον αὐτόν **(αὐτήν)** ἐν Παραδείσῳ, ὅπου χοροὶ τῶν Ἁγίων, Κύριε, καὶ οἱ δίκαιοι ἐκλάμπουσιν ὡς φωστῆρες, τὸν κεκοιμημένον δοῦλόν **(τὴν κεκοιμημένην δούλῃν)** σου ἀνάπαυσον, παρορῶν αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** πάντα τὰ ἐγκλήματα.

Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἁγίῳ Πνεύματι.

Τὸ τριλαμπές τῆς μιᾶς θεότητος, εὐσεβῶς ὑμνήσωμεν βοῶντες Ἅγιος εἶ, ὁ Πατὴρ ὁ ἄναρχος, ὁ συνάναρχος Υἱὸς καὶ θεῖον Πνεῦμα. Φώτισον ἡμᾶς πίστει σοι λατρεύοντας, καὶ τοῦ αἰωνίου πυρὸς ἐξάρπασον.

The Funeral Service

***Verse:** Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments.*

Of old You created me from nothing and honored me with Your Divine Image. But when I disobeyed Your commandment, You returned me to the earth from which I was taken. Lead me back again to Your likeness, so that the ancient beauty may be refashioned.

***Verse:** Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments.*

I am an image of Your ineffable glory, though I bear the scars of my transgressions. Take pity on me, the work of Your hands, Master, and cleanse me by Your compassion. Grant me the desired homeland for which I long, making me again a citizen of Paradise.

***Verse:** Blessed are You, O Lord, teach me Your commandments.*

Give rest, O God, to Your servant, and place him **(her)** in Paradise where the choirs of the saints and the righteous will shine as the stars of Heaven. To Your departed servant give rest, O Lord, overlooking all his **(her)** offenses.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Let us devoutly praise the threefold radiance of the one God as we sing: Holy are You, the Father without beginning, the coeternal Son, and the Divine Spirit. Illumine us who worship You in faith and deliver us from the eternal fire.

Ἡ Νεκρώσιμος Ἀκολουθία

Καὶ νῦν καὶ αἰεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν.

Χαῖρε σεμνή, ἡ Θεὸν σαρκὶ τεκοῦσα, εἰς πάντων σωτηρίαν, δι' ἧς γένος τῶν ἀνθρώπων εὐρατο τὴν σωτηρίαν, διὰ σοῦ εὐροισμεν Παράδεισον, Θεοτόκε, ἀγνή εὐλογημένη.

Ὁ Λαὸς ἐγείρεται ἐκ τῶν καθισμάτων.

Ἀλληλούια. Ἀλληλούια. Ἀλληλούια. Δόξα σοι ὁ Θεός. (γ')

Ψαλλομένου τοῦ «Μετὰ τῶν Ἀγίων...» ὁ Διάκονος (ἢ ὁ Τερεύς) θυμιᾷ τὴν σορόν τοῦ κοιμηθέντος κατὰ τὸν συνήθη τρόπον θυμιάσεως.

Κοντάκιον. Ἦχος πλ. δ'.

Μετὰ τῶν Ἀγίων ἀνάπαυσον, Χριστέ, τὴν ψυχὴν τοῦ δούλου (τῆς δούλης) σου, ἔνθα οὐκ ἔστι πόνος, οὐ λύπη, οὐ στεναγμός, ἀλλὰ ζωὴ ἀτελεύτητος.

Ὁ Λαὸς κάθεται.

**Νεκρώσιμα Τροπάρια
Ἁγίου Ἰωάννου τοῦ Δαμασκηνοῦ.**

Ἦχος α'.

Ποία τοῦ βίου τρυφὴ διαμένει λύπης ἀμέτοχος; Ποία δόξα ἔστηκεν ἐπὶ γῆς ἀμετάθετος; Πάντα σκιᾶς ἀσθενέστερα, πάντα ὀνείρων ἀπατηλότερα. Μία ῥοπή καὶ ταῦτα πάντα θάνατος διαδέχεται. Ἀλλ' ἐν τῷ φωτί, Χριστέ, τοῦ προσώπου σου, καὶ τῷ γλυκασμῷ τῆς σῆς ὠραιότητος, ὃν (ἦν) ἔξελέξω ἀνάπαυσον ὡς φιλανθρωπος.

The Funeral Service

Now and forever, and to the ages of ages. Amen.

Rejoice, gracious Lady, who gave birth to God in the flesh for the salvation of all, and through whom the human race has found salvation. Through you, pure and blessed Theotokos, may we find Paradise.

The Faithful stand from their seats.

Alleluia. Alleluia. Alleluia. Glory to You, O God. (3)

During the chanting of "With all the saints..." the Deacon (or Priest) censes the body of the deceased in the usual manner.

Kontakion. Mode pl. 4.

With all the saints give rest, O Christ, to the soul of Your servant, where there is no pain, no sorrow and no sighing, but life everlasting.

The Faithful Sit.

Funeral Hymns by Saint John of Damascus.

Mode 1.

Which of life's pleasures remains free of sorrow? Which earthly glory is permanent? All this is fainter than a shadow, all more illusive than a dream. In a single moment, death succeeds them all. O Christ, grant rest to him (**her**) whom You have taken, in the light of Your face and in the sweetness of Your beauty, as the One Who loves humanity.

Ἦχος β'.

Ὡς ἄνθος μαραίνεται, καὶ ὥς ὄναρ παρέρχεται, καὶ διαλύεται πᾶς ἄνθρωπος, πάλιν δὲ ἡχούσης τῆς σάλπιγγος, νεκροί, ὥς ἐν συσσεισμῷ, πάντες ἀναστήσονται πρὸς τὴν σὴν ὑπάντησιν, Χριστέ ὁ Θεός, τότε, Δέσποτα, ὃν (ἦν) μετέστησας ἐξ ἡμῶν, ἐν ταῖς τῶν Ἁγίων σου κατάταξον σκηναίς, τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ σοῦ δούλου **(τῆς σῆς δούλης)** Χριστέ.

Ἔτερον, ἐκτός σειρᾶς.

Ἦχος β'.

Οἶμοι, οἶον ἀγῶνα ἔχει ἡ ψυχὴ, χωριζομένη ἐκ τοῦ σώματος! Οἶμοι, πόσα δακρύει τότε, καὶ οὐχ ὑπάρχει ὁ ἐλεὼν αὐτήν! Πρὸς τοὺς, Ἀγγέλους τὰ ὄμματα ῥέπουσα, ἄπρακτα καθικετεύει, πρὸς τοὺς ἀνθρώπους τὰς χεῖρας ἐκτείνουσα, οὐκ ἔχει τὸν βοηθοῦντα. Διό, ἀγαπητοί μου ἀδελφοί, ἐννοήσαντες ἡμῶν τὸ βραχὺ τῆς ζωῆς, τῷ μεταστάντι **(τῇ μεταστάσει)** τὴν ἀνάπαυσιν, παρὰ Χριστοῦ αἰτησώμεθα, καὶ ταῖς ψυχαῖς ἡμῶν τὸ μέγα ἔλεος.

Ἦχος γ'.

Πάντα ματαιότης τὰ ἀνθρώπινά, ὅσα οὐχ ὑπάρχει μετὰ θάνατον, οὐ παραμένει ὁ πλοῦτος, οὐ συνοδεύει ἡ δόξα ἐπελθῶν γὰρ ὁ θάνατος, ταῦτα πάντα ἐξηφάνισται. Διό, Χριστῷ τῷ ἀθανάτῳ Βασιλεῖ βοηθώμεν. Τὸν μεταστάντα **(τὴν μεταστάσαν)** ἐξ ἡμῶν ἀνάπαυσον, ἔνθα πάντων ἐστὶν εὐφραινομένων ἡ κατοικία.

The Funeral Service

Mode 2.

A flower withers and a dream passes, and likewise every human being disintegrates. Then at the sound of the trumpet, as if in an earthquake, all the dead will rise to meet You, O Christ God. We pray You will then place the spirit of him (**her**) whom You have taken from us in the dwellings of Your Saints, O Christ.

An alternate in the same mode.

Mode 2.

Alas! Such agony afflicts a soul when it is separated from its body. Alas! How it weeps then, but there is no one to have mercy on it. It turns its eyes toward the Angels and prays to no avail. It reaches for other people, but there is no one who can help. Therefore, my beloved brethren, let us realize how short is our life, and let us pray to Christ to grant repose to the departed, and great mercy to our souls.

Mode 3.

Vanity is everything human, which after death exists no more. Wealth does not remain, glory does not go with us; for when death arrives, all these disappear. Therefore let us cry to Christ the immortal King, "Grant rest to him (**her**) departed from us, where all those who are glad have their dwelling in You."

Ἦχος δ'.

Ἐδωκας σημείωσιν.

Ὅντως φοβερώτατον τὸ τοῦ θανάτου μυστήριον, πῶς ψυχὴ ἐκ τοῦ σώματος, βιαίως χωρίζεται ἐκ τῆς ἁρμονίας, καὶ τῆς συμφυΐας ὁ φυσικώτατος δεσμός, θείῳ βουλήματι ἀποτέμνεται. Διὸ σὲ ἱκετεύομεν. Τὸν μεταστάντα **(τὴν μεταστᾶσαν)** ἀνάπαυσον, ἐν σκηναῖς τῶν δικαίων σου, ζωοδότα φιλάνθρωπε.

Ἔτερον, ἐκτός σειρᾶς.

Ἦχος δ'.

Ποῦ ἐστὶν ἡ τοῦ κόσμου προσπάθεια; Ποῦ ἐστὶν ἡ τῶν προσκαίρων φαντασία; Ποῦ ἐστὶν ὁ χρυσὸς καὶ ὁ ἄργυρος; Ποῦ ἐστὶ τῶν ἱκετῶν ἡ πλημμύρα καὶ ὁ θόρυβος; Πάντα κόνις, πάντα τέφρα, πάντα σκιά. Ἀλλὰ δεῦτε βοήσωμεν τῷ ἀθανάτῳ Βασιλεῖ. Κύριε, τῶν αἰωνίων σου ἀγαθῶν ἀξιώσον τὸν μεταστάντα **(τὴν μεταστᾶσαν)** ἐξ ἡμῶν, ἀναπαύων αὐτόν **(αὐτήν)** ἐν τῇ ἀγήρῳ μακαριότητι.

Ἦχος πλ. α'.

Ἐμνήσθην τοῦ Προφήτου βοῶντος· «Ἐγὼ εἰμι γῆ καὶ σποδός» **(Γεν. ιθ', 27)**, καὶ πάλιν κατενόησα ἐν τοῖς μνήμασι καὶ εἶδον τὰ ὅσα τὰ γεγυμνωμένα καὶ εἶπον· Ἄρα τίς ἐστι, βασιλεύς ἢ στρατιώτης, ἢ πλούσιος ἢ πένης, ἢ δίκαιος ἢ ἁμαρτωλός; Ἀλλὰ ἀνάπαυσον, Κύριε, μετὰ δικαίων τὸν δούλόν **(τὴν δούλῃν)** σου ὡς φιλάνθρωπος.

The Funeral Service

Mode 4.

You have given.

Frightening indeed, and quite so, is the mystery known as death, how a soul then is forcibly * separated from its frame, parting from its body; * severed is that union, which is most natural and innate, * by Your divine will, O Lover of mankind. * And therefore we entreat You grant to the departed eternal rest, * where the saints and the righteous dwell, * O our God and the Giver of life.

An alternate in the same mode.

Mode 4.

Where are all those worldly attachments? Where are the imaginings of things that do not last? Where is the gold, where the silver? Where is the flood and fuss of assistants and servants? All of this is dust and ashes, all just a shadow. Nevertheless, come let us say to the immortal King, "Lord, grant Your eternal good things to him (**her**) departed from us, and give him (**her**) rest in unending blessedness."

Mode pl. 1.

I remembered how the Prophet once said: "I am but dust and earth" (**Gen. 18:27**); and then I looked into the graves and saw the naked bones, and in turn I exclaimed: "Who can tell, which one was a king, which one a soldier, rich or poor, a righteous man or a sinner?" Nevertheless, O Lord, grant that Your servant may rest with the righteous, in Your love for humanity.

Ἦχος πλ. β'.

Ἀρχή μοι καὶ ὑπόστασις, τὸ πλαστοργόν σου γέγονε πρόσταγμα. Βουληθεὶς γὰρ ἐξ ἀοράτου τε, καὶ ὁρατῆς μὲ ζῶον συμπῆξαι φύσεως, γῆθεν μου τὸ σῶμα διέπλασας, δέδωκας δὲ μοι ψυχὴν, τῇ θείᾳ σου καὶ ζωοποιῷ ἐμπνεύσει. Διό, Χριστέ, τὸν δούλόν (**τὴν δούλην**) σου, ἐν χάρα ζώντων, ἐν σκηναῖς δικαίων ἀνάπαυσον.

Ἦχος βαρύν.

Οὐκέτι κωλυόμεθα.

Ἀνάπαυσον, Σωτὴρ ἡμῶν ζωοδότα, ὃν μετέστησας ἀδελφόν (**ἦν μετέστησας ἀδελφήν**) ἡμῶν, ἐκ τῶν προσκαίρων, κράζοντα (**κράζουσαν**) δόξα σοι.

Ἔτερον, ἐκτός σειρᾶς.

Ἦχος βαρύν.

Κατ' εἰκόνα σὴν καὶ ὁμοίωσιν, πλαστοργήσας κατ' ἀρχὰς τὸν ἄνθρωπον, ἐν Παραδείσῳ τέθεικας κατάρχειν σου τῶν κτισμάτων, φθόνῳ δὲ διαβόλου ἀπατηθεὶς, τῆς βρώσεως μετέσχε, τῶν ἐντολῶν σου παραβάτης γεγωνώς, διὸ πάλιν εἰς γῆν ἐξῆς ἐλήφθη, κατεδίκασας ἐπιστρέφειν, Κύριε, καὶ αἰτεῖσθαι τὴν ἀνάπαυσιν.

Ἦχος πλ. δ'.

Θρηνῶ καὶ ὀδύρομαι, ὅταν ἐννοήσω τὸν θάνατον, καὶ ἴδω ἐν τοῖς τάφοις κειμένην τὴν κατ' εἰκόνα Θεοῦ, πλασθεῖσαν ἡμῖν ὠραιότητα, ἄμορφον, ἄδοξον, μὴ ἔχουσαν εἶδος. ὦ τοῦ θαύματος! Τὶ τὸ περὶ ἡμᾶς τοῦτο γέγονε μυστήριον; Πῶς παρεδόθημεν τῇ φθορᾷ, καὶ συνεζεύχθημεν τῷ θανάτῳ; Ὦντως Θεοῦ προστάξει, ὡς γέγραπται, τοῦ παρέχοντος τοῖς μεταστᾶσι τὴν ἀνάπαυσιν.

The Funeral Service

Mode pl. 2.

Your creative command was my beginning and real existence; for wishing to construct me as a living creature from both visible and invisible natures, You fashioned my body from earth, and You gave me a soul by Your divine and life-creating breath. Therefore, O Christ, give rest to Your servant in the land of the living where the righteous dwell.

Mode grave.

No longer are we barred.

O Savior and Giver of life, to him **(her)** You transferred *
from this fleeting life, grant rest, as he **(she)** cries out, *
"Glory to You."

An alternate in the same mode.

Mode grave.

In the beginning, when You fashioned man in Your Image and Likeness, You put him in Paradise to have dominion over Your creation. But by the envy of the devil, man was deceived; and he ate the fruit and thus became a transgressor of Your commandments. Therefore, O Lord, You sentenced him to return to the earth, from which he had been taken, and to pray for repose.

Mode pl. 4.

I grieve and I lament when I think about death, and when I see the beauty, which God made for us in His Image, lying formless in the grave, without glory and unsightly. O the wonder of it! What is this mystery that happened to us? How were we given over to decay and coupled with death? Indeed, as it is written, this is all by the command of God, Who grants repose to those who have departed.

Ἡ Νεκρώσιμος Ἀκολουθία

Ὁ Λαὸς ἐγείρεται ἐκ τῶν καθισμάτων.

Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἁγίῳ Πνεύματι.

Ὁ θάνατός σου, Κύριε, ἀθανασίας γέγονε πρόξενος, εἰ μὴ γὰρ ἐν μνήματι κατετέθης, οὐκ ἂν ὁ Παράδεισος ἠνέωκτο, διὸ τὸν μεταστάντα (τὴν μεταστᾶσαν) ἀνάπαυσον ὡς φιλάνθρωπος.

Καὶ νῦν καὶ αἰεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν.

Ἀγνή Παρθένε τοῦ Λόγου Πύλη, τοῦ Θεοῦ ἡμῶν Μήτηρ, ἰκέτευε ἐλεηθῆναι τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ (αὐτῆς).



Οἱ Μακαρισμοὶ
Ἦχος πλ. β'.
ὁ α' Χορός



Στίχ. Ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου. Μακάριοι οἱ πτωχοὶ τῷ πνεύματι, ὅτι αὐτῶν ἐστὶν ἡ βασιλεία τῶν οὐρανῶν.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ β' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ πενθοῦντες, ὅτι αὐτοὶ παρακληθήσονται. Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ α' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ πραεῖς, ὅτι αὐτοὶ κληρονομήσουσι τὴν γῆν.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

The Funeral Service

The Faithful stand from their seats.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Your death O Lord, became the cause of immortality. For if You had not been placed in the Tomb, Paradise would not have opened. Therefore, grant rest to the departed, O Friend of man.

Now and forever, and to the ages of ages. Amen.

O pure Virgin, you are the Gate of the Logos as the Mother of our God. We pray you to entreat Him to have mercy on his (**her**) soul.



The Beatitudes Mode pl. 2. 1st Choir



Verse: *In Your Kingdom, remember us, Lord when You come into Your Kingdom. Blessed are the poor in spirit for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

2nd Choir

Verse: *Blessed are they who mourn, for they shall be comforted.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

1st Choir

Verse: *Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the Earth.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

ὁ β' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ πεινῶντες καὶ διψῶντες τὴν δικαιοσύνην,
ὅτι αὐτοὶ χορτασθήσονται.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ α' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ ἐλεήμονες, ὅτι αὐτοὶ ἐλεηθήσονται.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ β' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ καθαροὶ τῇ καρδίᾳ, ὅτι αὐτοὶ τὸν Θεὸν
ὄψονται.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ α' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ εἰρηνοποιοί, ὅτι αὐτοὶ υἱοὶ Θεοῦ
κληθήσονται.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ β' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι οἱ δεδιωγμένοι ἕνεκεν δικαιοσύνης, ὅτι
αὐτῶν ἐστὶν ἡ βασιλεία τῶν οὐρανῶν.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ α' Χορός

Στίχ. Μακάριοι ἐστε, ὅταν ὀνειδίσωσιν ὑμᾶς, καὶ διώξωσι,
καὶ εἰπῶσι πᾶν πονηρὸν ῥῆμα καθ' ὑμῶν, ψευδόμενοι
ἕνεκεν ἐμοῦ.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

The Funeral Service

2nd Choir

Verse: *Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be satisfied.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

1st Choir

Verse: *Blessed are the merciful, for they shall find mercy.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

2nd Choir

Verse: *Blessed are the pure of heart, for they shall see God.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

1st Choir

Verse: *Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called sons of God.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

2nd Choir

Verse: *Blessed are they who are persecuted for righteousness' sake, for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

1st Choir

Verse: *Blessed are you when men revile you and persecute you, saying evil against you falsely for My sake.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

ὁ β' Χορός

Στίχ. Χαίρετε καὶ ἀγαλλιᾶσθε, ὅτι ὁ μισθὸς ὑμῶν πολὺς ἐν τοῖς οὐρανοῖς.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ α' Χορός

Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἀγίῳ Πνεύματι.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

ὁ β' Χορός

Καὶ νῦν καὶ αἰὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν.

Μνήσθητι ἡμῶν, Κύριε, ὅταν ἔλθῃς ἐν τῇ βασιλείᾳ σου.

Προκείμενον. Ἦχος γ'.

Μακαρία ἡ ὁδός, ἣ πορεύῃ σήμερον, ὅτι ἡτοιμάσθη σοι τόπος ἀναπαύσεως. (γ')

Ὁ Λαὸς κάθεται.

**Τὰ Ἀναγνώσματα
Ὁ Απόστολος**

Διάκονος: Πρόσχωμεν.

Αναγνώστης: Πρὸς σέ, Κύριε, κεκράξομαι, ὁ Θεός μου.

Διάκονος: Σοφία.

Αναγνώστης: Πρὸς Θεσσαλονικεῖς Α' Ἐπιστολῆς Παύλου τὸ ἀνάγνωσμα. (δ', 13-17)

Διάκονος: Πρόσχωμεν.

The Funeral Service

2nd Choir

Verse: *Rejoice and be glad, for great is your reward in Heaven.*

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

1st Choir

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

2nd Choir

Now and forever, and to the ages of ages. Amen.

Remember us, O Lord, when You come into Your Kingdom.

Prokeimenon. Mode 3.

Blessed is the way, in which you journey today, for a place of rest, has been prepared for you. (3)

The Faithful Sit.

The Readings

The Epistle

Deacon: Let us be attentive.

Reader: Upon you will I call, O my God.

Deacon: Wisdom.

Reader: The reading is from the First Epistle of Saint Paul to the Thessalonians. (4:13-17)

Deacon: Let us be attentive.

Ἡ Νεκρώσιμος Ἀκολουθία

Ἀναγνώστης: Ἀδελφοί, οὐ θέλω ὑμᾶς ἀγνοεῖν περὶ τῶν κεκοιμημένων, ἵνα μὴ λυπῆσθε καθὼς καὶ οἱ λοιποὶ οἱ μὴ ἔχοντες ἐλπίδα. Εἰ γὰρ πιστεύομεν ὅτι Ἰησοῦς ἀπέθανε καὶ ἀνέστη, οὕτω καὶ ὁ Θεὸς τοὺς κοιμηθέντας διὰ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ ἄξει σὺν αὐτῷ. Τοῦτο γὰρ ὑμῖν λέγομεν ἐν λόγῳ Κυρίου, ὅτι ἡμεῖς οἱ ζῶντες, οἱ περιλειπόμενοι εἰς τὴν παρουσίαν τοῦ Κυρίου, οὐ μὴ φθάσωμεν τοὺς κοιμηθέντας, ὅτι αὐτὸς ὁ Κύριος, ἐν κελεύσματι, ἐν φωνῇ ἀρχαγγέλου καὶ ἐν σάλπιγγι Θεοῦ, καταβήσεται ἀπ' οὐρανοῦ καὶ οἱ νεκροὶ ἐν Χριστῷ ἀναστήσονται πρῶτον, ἔπειτὰ ἡμεῖς οἱ ζῶντες οἱ περιλειπόμενοι, ἅμα σὺν αὐτοῖς ἄρπαγησόμεθα ἐν νεφέλαις εἰς ἀπάντησιν τοῦ Κυρίου εἰς ἄερα, καὶ οὕτω πάντοτε σὺν Κυρίῳ ἐσόμεθα.

Ἱερεὺς: Εἰρήνη σοι.

Λαός: Ἀλληλούια. Ἀλληλούια. Ἀλληλούια.

Ὁ Λαός ἐγείρεται ἐκ τῶν καθισμάτων.

Τὸ Ἱερόν Εὐαγγέλιον

Καὶ μετὰ τὸ Ἀλληλούια, ὁ Διάκονος λέγει ἀπὸ τῆς Ωραίας Πύλης·

Διάκονος: Σοφία. Ὁρθοῖ. Ἀκούσωμεν τοῦ ἁγίου Εὐαγγελίου.

Καὶ εὐλογῶν τὸν Λαὸν λέγει·

Ἱερεὺς: Εἰρήνη πᾶσι.

Λαός: Καὶ τῷ πνεύματί σου.

Ἱερεὺς: Ἐκ τοῦ κατὰ Ἰωάννην ἁγίου Εὐαγγελίου τὸ ἀνάγνωσμα. (ε', 24-30)

Διάκονος: Πρόσχωμεν.

Λαός: Δόξα σοι, Κύριε, δόξα σοι.

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Reader: Brethren, we would not have you ignorant concerning those who are asleep, that you may not grieve as others do who have no hope. For since we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so, through Jesus, God will bring with Him those who have fallen asleep. For this we declare to you by the word of the Lord, that we who are alive, who are left until the coming of the Lord, shall not precede those who have fallen asleep. For the Lord Himself will descend from Heaven with a cry of command with the Archangel's call, and with the sound of the trumpet of God. And the dead in Christ will rise first; then we who are alive, who are left, shall be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air, and we shall always be with the Lord.

Priest: Peace be with you.

People: Alleluia. Alleluia. Alleluia.

The Faithful Stand from their seats.

The Holy Gospel

After the Alleluia, the Deacon says from the Royal Doors:

Deacon: Wisdom. Arise. Let us hear the Holy Gospel.

Blessing the People, the Priest says:

Priest: Peace be with all.

People: And with your spirit.

Priest: The reading is from the Holy Gospel according to Saint John. (5:24-30)

Deacon: Let us be attentive.

People: Glory to You, O Lord, glory to You.

Ἡ Νεκρώσιμος Ἀκολουθία

Ἰερεὺς: Εἶπεν ὁ Κύριος πρὸς τοὺς ἐληλυθότας πρὸς αὐτὸν Ἰουδαίους: Ἀμήν, ἀμήν λέγω ὑμῖν ὅτι ὁ τὸν λόγον μου ἀκούων καὶ πιστεύων τῷ πέμψαντί με, ἔχει ζωὴν αἰώνιον, καὶ εἰς κρίσιν οὐκ ἔρχεται, ἀλλὰ μεταβέβηκεν ἐκ τοῦ θανάτου εἰς τὴν ζωὴν. Ἀμήν, ἀμήν λέγω ὑμῖν ὅτι ἔρχεται ὥρα, καὶ νῦν ἐστίν, ὅτε οἱ νεκροὶ ἀκούσονται τῆς φωνῆς τοῦ Υἱοῦ τοῦ Θεοῦ καὶ οἱ ἀκούσαντες ζήσονται. Ὡςπερ γὰρ ὁ Πατὴρ ἔχει ζωὴν ἐν ἑαυτῷ, οὕτως ἔδωκε καὶ τῷ Υἱῷ ζωὴν ἔχειν ἐν ἑαυτῷ καὶ ἐξουσίαν ἔδωκεν αὐτῷ καὶ κρίσιν ποιεῖν, ὅτι υἱὸς ἀνθρώπου ἐστίν. Μὴ θαυμάζετε τοῦτο, ὅτι ἔρχεται ὥρα, ἐν ἣ πάντες οἱ ἐν τοῖς μνημείοις ἀκούσονται τῆς φωνῆς αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐκπορεύσονται, οἱ τὰ ἀγαθὰ ποιήσαντες εἰς ἀνάστασιν ζωῆς, οἱ δὲ τὰ φαῦλα πράξαντες εἰς ἀνάστασιν κρίσεως, οὐ δύναμαι ἐγὼ ποιεῖν ἀπ' ἑμαυτοῦ οὐδέν. Καθὼς ἀκούω κρίνω, καὶ ἡ κρίσις ἡ ἐμὴ δικαία ἐστίν, ὅτι οὐ ζητῶ τὸ θέλημα τὸ ἐμὸν ἀλλὰ τὸ θέλημα τοῦ πέμψαντός με Πατρός.

Λαός: Δόξα σοι, Κύριε, δόξα σοι.

Ἡ Δέησις

Διάκονος: Ἐλέησον ἡμᾶς ὁ Θεός, κατὰ τὸ μέγα ἔλεός σου, δεόμεθά σου, ἐπάκουσον καὶ ἐλέησον.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον. (γ')

Διάκονος: Ἐτι δεόμεθα ὑπὲρ ἀναπαύσεως τῆς ψυχῆς τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου (τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης) τοῦ Θεοῦ (δεῖνα), καὶ ὑπὲρ τοῦ συγχωρηθῆναι αὐτῷ (αὐτῇ) πᾶν πλημμέλημα ἐκούσιόν τε καὶ ἀκούσιον.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον. (γ')

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Priest: The Lord said to the Jews who came to Him: Truly, truly, I say to you, he who hears My word and believes him Who sent Me, has eternal life; he does not come into judgment, but has passed from death to life. Truly, truly, I say to you, the hour is coming, and now is, when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who hear will live. For as the Father has life in Himself, so He has granted the Son also to have life in Himself, and has given Him the authority to execute judgment, because He is the Son of Man. Do not marvel at this; for the hour is coming when all who are in the tombs will hear His voice and come forth, those who have done good, to the resurrection of life, and those who have done evil, to the resurrection of judgment. I can do nothing on My own authority; as I hear, I judge; and My judgment is just, because I seek not My own will but the will of the Father Who sent Me.

People: Glory to You, O Lord, glory to You.

The Litany

Deacon: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Your great mercy, we pray to You, hear us and have mercy.

People: Lord, have mercy. (3)

Deacon: Again we pray for the repose of the soul of the departed servant of God (*name*), who has fallen asleep, and for the forgiveness of all his (**her**) sins, both voluntary and involuntary.

People: Lord, have mercy. (3)

Διάκονος: Ὅπως Κύριος ὁ Θεὸς τάξη τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ (αὐτῆς) ἔνθα οἱ δίκαιοι ἀναπαύονται, τὰ ἐλέη τοῦ Θεοῦ, τὴν βασιλείαν τῶν οὐρανῶν καὶ ἄφεσιν τῶν αὐτοῦ (αὐτῆς) ἁμαρτιῶν, παρὰ Χριστῷ τῷ ἀθανάτῳ Βασιλεῖ καὶ Θεῷ ἡμῶν αἰτησώμεθα.

Λαός: Παράσχου, Κύριε.

Ἐὰν δέ παρίσταται Ἀρχιερεὺς, πρὸ τῆς κάτωθι εὐχῆς ἀναγινώσκει ἑτέραν συγχωρητικὴν εὐχήν, διὰ τὴν ὁποῖαν βλ. σελ. 48.

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

Εὐχή

Ἱερεύς: Ὁ Θεὸς τῶν πνευμάτων καὶ πάσης σαρκός, ὁ τὸν θάνατον καταπατήσας τὸν δὲ διάβολον καταργήσας καὶ ζωὴν τῷ κόσμῳ σου δωρησάμενος. αὐτός, Κύριε, ἀνάπαυσον καὶ τὴν ψυχὴν τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου (τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης) σου (*δεῖνα*), ἐν τόπῳ φωτεινῷ, ἐν τόπῳ χλοερῷ, ἐν τόπῳ ἀναψύξεως, ἔνθα ἀπέδρα ὁδύνη, λύπη καὶ στεναγμός. Πάν ἁμάρτημα τὸ παρ' αὐτοῦ (αὐτῆς)πραχθὲν ἐν λόγῳ ἢ ἔργῳ ἢ διανοίᾳ, ὡς ἀγαθὸς καὶ φιλόανθρωπος Θεὸς συγχώρησον, ὅτι οὐκ ἔστιν ἄνθρωπος ὃς ζήσεται καὶ οὐχ ἁμαρτήσῃ, σὺ γὰρ μόνος, ἐκτὸς ἁμαρτίας ὑπάρχεις, ἡ δικαιοσύνη σου, δικαιοσύνη εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα, καὶ ὁ λόγος σου ἀλήθεια.

Καὶ ἐκφωνεῖ·

Ἱερεύς: Ὅτι σὺ εἶ ἡ ἀνάστασις, ἡ ζωὴ, καὶ ἡ ἀνάπαυσις τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου (τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης) σου (*δεῖνα*), Χριστὲ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, καὶ σοὶ τὴν δόξαν ἀναπέμπομεν, σὺν τῷ ἀνάρχῳ σου Πατρί, καὶ τῷ παναγίῳ καὶ ἀγαθῷ καὶ ζωοποιῷ σου Πνεύματι, νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

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Deacon: May the Lord God grant his **(her)** soul rest where the righteous repose, let us ask for the mercies of God, the Kingdom of Heaven and the forgiveness of his **(her)** sins, from Christ our immortal King and God.

People: Grant this, O Lord.

If there is a Hierarch presiding, before the following prayers he reads other prayers of forgiveness which are found on page 49.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Prayer

Priest: O God of spirits and of all flesh, You trampled upon death and abolished the power of the Devil, giving life to Your world. Give rest to the soul of Your departed servant **(name)**, who has fallen asleep, in a place of light, in a place of green pasture, in a place of refreshment, from where pain, sorrow and sighing have fled away. As a good and loving God, forgive every sin he **(she)** has committed in word, deed or thought, for there is no one who lives and does not sin. You alone are without sin. Your righteousness is an everlasting righteousness and Your word is truth.

And he exclaims:

Priest: For You are the Resurrection, the Life and the Repose of Your departed servant **(name)**, who has fallen asleep, O Christ our God, and to You we offer up glory, with Your eternal Father Who is without beginning and Your all-holy, good and life-creating Spirit, now and forever, and to the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

Ἡ Νεκρώσιμος Ἀκολουθία

Ἐάν δέ παρίστανται περισσότεροι τοῦ ἑνός Ἱερεῖς, τότε ἡ αἴτησις ἐπαναλαμβάνεται διαδοχικῶς ἐξ ἑνός ἑκάστου κατὰ τὴν σειρὰν τῶν πρεσβειῶν.

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

Ἱερεὺς: Ὅτι σὺ εἶ ἡ ἀνάστασις, ἡ ζωὴ, καὶ ἡ ἀνάπαυσις τοῦ κεκοιμημένου δούλου **(τῆς κεκοιμημένης δούλης)** σου **(δεῖνα)**, Χριστὲ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, καὶ σοὶ τὴν δόξαν ἀναπέμπομεν, σὺν τῷ ἀνάρχῳ σου Πατρὶ, καὶ τῷ παναγίῳ καὶ ἀγαθῷ καὶ ζωοποιῷ σου Πνεύματι, νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Ὁ Ἱερεὺς ἐκφωνεῖ πρὸς τὸν Λαόν·

Ἀπόλυσις

Ἱερεὺς: Δόξα σοι ὁ Θεός, ἡ ἐλπίς ἡμῶν, δόξα σοι.

Διάκονος: Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἀγίῳ Πνεύματι, καὶ νῦν καὶ ἀεὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν. Κύριε, ἐλέησον. **(γ')** Δέσποτα ἅγιε, εὐλόγησον.

Ἱερεὺς: Ὁ καὶ νεκρῶν καὶ ζώντων τὴν ἐξουσίαν ἔχων ὡς ἀθάνατος Βασιλεὺς, καὶ ἀναστὰς ἐκ νεκρῶν, Χριστὸς ὁ ἀληθινὸς Θεὸς ἡμῶν, ταῖς πρεσβείαις τῆς παναχράντου καὶ παναμώμου ἁγίας αὐτοῦ Μητρός, τῶν ἁγίων ἐνδόξων καὶ πανευφύμων Ἀποστόλων, τῶν ὁσίων καὶ θεοφόρων Πατέρων ἡμῶν, τῶν ἁγίων ἐνδόξων Προπατόρων Ἀβραάμ, Ἰσαὰκ καὶ Ἰακώβ, τοῦ ὁσίου καὶ δικαίου φίλου αὐτοῦ Λαζάρου τοῦ τετραήμερου, καὶ πάντων των Ἀγίων,

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If there is more than one Priest serving, the following petition is repeated by each Priest in order of seniority.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Priest: For You are the Resurrection, the Life and the Repose of Your departed servant *(name)*, who has fallen asleep, O Christ our God, and to You we offer up glory, with Your eternal Father Who is without beginning and Your all-holy, good and life-creating Spirit, now and forever, and to the ages of ages.

People: Amen.

The Priest, facing the People, exclaims:

Dismissal

Priest: Glory to You, O God, our Hope, glory to You.

Deacon: Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and forever and to the ages of ages. Amen. Lord, have mercy. (3) Holy Master, give the blessing.

Priest: Lord of the living and the dead, the immortal King and Risen Christ, our true God, through the intercessions of His all-pure and all-immaculate holy Mother; of the holy, glorious and praiseworthy Apostles; of our righteous and God-bearing Fathers; of the holy and glorious Forefathers, Abraham, Isaac and Jacob; of His holy and righteous friend Lazarus, who lay in the grave four days; and of all the saints; place the soul of His servant *(name)*, departed from us, in the

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τὴν ψυχὴν τοῦ ἐξ ἡμῶν μεταστάντος δούλου (τῆς ἐξ ἡμῶν μεταστάσης δούλης) αὐτοῦ (δεῖνα), ἐν σκηναῖς δικαίων τάξαι, ἐν κόλποις, Ἀβραὰμ ἀναπαῦσαι, καὶ μετὰ δικαίων συναριθμηῆσαι, ἡμᾶς δ' ἐλεῆσαι καὶ σῶσαι ὡς ἀγαθὸς καὶ φιλόανθρωπος καὶ ἐλεήμων Θεός.

Ἱερεὺς: Αἰωνία σου ἡ μνήμη ἀξιομακάριστε καὶ ἀείμνηστε ἀδελφεὲ (ἀδελφή) ἡμῶν. (γ')

Λαός: Αἰωνία ἡ μνήμη, αἰωνία ἡ μνήμη, αἰωνία αὐτοῦ, (αὐτῆς) ἡ μνήμη. (γ')

Ὁ Λαὸς κάθεται.

Ψαλλομένων δέ τῶν κάτωθι ὕμνων, ὁ Λαὸς πλησιάζει τὸ νεκρὸν καὶ ἀποτίει τὸν δέοντα σεβασμὸν, διὰ τοῦ τελευταίου ἀσπασμοῦ.

Κατὰ δε τὴν Πασχάλιον Περίοδον ἀντὶ τῶν ὕμνων τούτων, ψάλλεται τὸ Ἀναστάσιμον Δοξαστικόν «Ἀναστάσεως ἡμέρα.»

Ἦχος β'.

Ὅτε ἐκ τοῦ ξύλου σὲ νεκρὸν.

Δεῦτε τελευταῖον ἀσπασμὸν, δῶμεν ἀδελφοί τῷ θανόντι (τῇ θανούσῃ), εὐχαριστοῦντες Θεῷ, οὗτος (αὕτη) γὰρ ἐξέλιπε τῆς συγγενείας αὐτοῦ (αὐτῆς), καὶ πρὸς τάφον ἐπείγεται, οὐκ ἐτι φροντίζων (φροντίζουσα), τὰ τῆς ματαιότητος καὶ πολυμόχθου σαρκός. Ποὺ νῦν συγγενεῖς τε καὶ φίλοι; Ἄρτι χωριζόμεθα ὄνπερ (ἦνπερ), ἀναπαῦσαι Κύριος ἐξώμεθα.

Ποῖος χωρισμός, ὦ ἀδελφοί, ποῖος κοπετός, ποῖος θρῆνος, ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ῥοπή! Δεῦτε οὖν ἀσπάσασθε τὸν (τήν) πρὸ μικροῦ μεθ' ἡμῶν, παραδίδοται τάφῳ γάρ, καλύπτεται λίθῳ, σκότει κατοικίζεται, νεκροῖς

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dwelling place of the righteous; give rest to him **(her)** in the bosom of Abraham, and number him **(her)** among the saints; and have mercy on us, and save us, for He is good and loves mankind.

Priest: Everlasting be your memory you who are worthy of eternal blessedness and eternal memory. (3)

People: Eternal memory, eternal memory, may his **(her)** memory be ever eternal. (3)

The Faithful Sit.

While the following hymns are being chanted, the People come forward to the deceased and with great reverence, they give a final kiss.

During the Easter period, instead of these hymns, the Resurrectional Doxastikon "It is the day of the Resurrection" is chanted.

Mode 2.

When he took You.

Brethren, let us give a final kiss * of farewell to him **(her)** who is dead now, and offer thanks to God. * For he **(she)** has departed from his **(her)** friends and family. * He **(She)** is ready for burial, no longer concerned with * anything of vanity or of the weary flesh. * Where now are the friends and the family? * Therefore let us pray to the Lord God, * that He will give rest to him **(her)** who parts from us.

Brethren, separation is so hard. * Such a lamentation, such grieving, at this grave turn of events. * Come to kiss him **(her)** who was with us just a short time ago. * He **(She)** is taken for burial, and lies six feet under, * dwelling in the

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συνθάπτεται. Πάντες συγγενεῖς τε καὶ φίλοι, ἄρτι χωριζόμεθα ὄνπερ **(ἦνπερ)**, ἀναπαῦσαι Κύριος εὐξόμεθα.

Σῶζε τοὺς ἐλπίζοντας εἰς σέ, Μήτηρ τοῦ ἀδύτου Ἡλίου, Θεογεννήτρια, αἴτησαι πρεσβείαις σου τὸν Ὑπεράγαθον, ἀναπαῦσαι δεόμεθα, τὸν νῦν μεταστάντα **(τὴν νῦν μεταστᾶσαν)**, ἔνθα ἀναπαύονται αἱ τῶν δικαίων ψυχαί, θείων ἀγαθῶν κληρονόμον, δεῖξον ἐν αὐλαῖς τῶν δικαίων εἰς μνημόσυνον, Πανάμωμε, αἰώνιον.

Δόξα Πατρὶ καὶ Υἱῷ καὶ Ἁγίῳ Πνεύματι.

Ἦχος πλ. β'.

Ὅρωντές με ἄφωνον καὶ ἄπνουν προκείμενον, κλαύσατε πάντες ἐπ' ἐμοί, ἀδελφοὶ καὶ φίλοι, συγγενεῖς καὶ γνωστοί· τὴν γὰρ χθὲς ἡμέραν μεθ' ὑμῶν ἐλάλουν, καὶ ἄφνω ἐπῆλθέ μοι ἡ φοβερά ὥρα τοῦ θανάτου. Ἀλλὰ δεῦτε πάντες οἱ ποθούμενοί με, καὶ ἀσπάσασθέ με τὸν τελευταῖον ἀσπασμόν· οὐκ ἔτι γὰρ μεθ' ὑμῶν πορεύσομαι, ἢ συλλαλήσω τοῦ λοιποῦ· εἰς κριτὴν γὰρ ἀπέρχομαι, ἔνθα προσωποληψία οὐκ ἔστι· δοῦλος γὰρ καὶ δεσπότης ὁμοῦ παρίστανται, βασιλεὺς καὶ στρατιώτης, πλούσιος καὶ πένης, ἐν ἀξιώματι ἴσω· ἕκαστος γὰρ ἐκ τῶν ἰδίων ἔργων ἢ δοξασθήσεται ἢ αἰσχυνθήσεται. Ἀλλ' αἰτῶ πάντας καὶ δυσωπῶ, ἀδιαλείπτως ὑπὲρ ἐμοῦ προσεύχεσθαι Χριστῷ τῷ Θεῷ, ἵνα μὴ καταταγῶ διὰ τὰς ἁμαρτίας μου, εἰς τὸν τόπον τῆς βασάνου, ἀλλ' ἵνα με κατατάξῃ, ὅπου τὸ φῶς τῆς ζωῆς.

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darkness now, buried alongside the dead. * Come, now, all his **(her)** friends and his **(her)** family. * Fervently we pray to the Lord God, * that He will give rest to him **(her)** who parts from us.

Save those who have placed their hope in you, * Mother of the Sun never-setting, and Theotokos all-pure. * We entreat you pray to God the most benevolent, * that He grant everlasting rest, * by your intercessions, * to the one departed, where the souls of the righteous repose. * Grant that he **(she)** inherit the good things * that our God prepared, in the dwellings * of the righteous, for eternal memory.

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit.

Mode pl. 2.

Looking at me as I lie here prone before you, voiceless and breathless, mourn for me, everyone—brethren and friends, kindred, and you who knew me well; for but yesterday with you I was talking, and suddenly there came upon me the fearful hour of death: Therefore come, all you that long for me, and kiss me with the last kiss of parting. For no longer shall I walk with you, nor talk with you henceforth; for to the Judge I go, where no person is valued for his **(her)** earthly station. Yea, slave and master together stand before Him, king and soldier, rich man and poor man, all accounted of equal rank; for each one, according to his **(her)** own deeds shall be glorified, or shall be put to shame. Therefore I beg you all, and implore you, to offer prayer unceasingly for me to Christ our God, that I be not assigned for my sins to the place of torment; but that He assign me to the place where there is Light of Life.

Θεοτοκίον.

**Καὶ νῦν καὶ αἰὶ καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων. Ἀμήν.
Ὁ αὐτός.**

Πρεσβείαις τῆς τεκοῦσης σε, Χριστέ, καὶ τῶν Μαρτύρων σου, Αποστόλων, Προφητῶν, Ἱεραρχῶν, Ὁσίων καὶ Δικαίων, καὶ πάντων τῶν Ἁγίων, τὸν κοιμηθέντα δοῦλόν σου ἀνάπαυσον.

Κατὰ τὴν παράδοσιν, ὁ ραντισμὸς δι' ἐλαίου καὶ γαίας γίνεται εἰς τὸ νεκροταφεῖον, πρὸ τοῦ ἐνταφιασμοῦ. Ὅμως διὰ πρακτικούς λόγους, συνήθως γίνεται εἰς τὸν Ναόν, εὐθύς μετὰ τὸν τελευταῖον ἀσπασμόν.

Μετὰ τὴν Απόλυσιν ὁ Ἱερεὺς συνοδεύει τὸ νεκρὸν ἀπὸ τοῦ Σολέως ἕως τοῦ Νάρθηκος, φέρων θυμιατόν καὶ τὸν σταυρόν εὐλογίας, ἐνῶ ὁ Λαὸς ψάλλει ἀργῶς τὸ «Ἅγιος ὁ Θεός.»

Κατὰ δέ τὴν Πασχάλιον Περίοδον ἀντὶ τοῦ «Ἅγιος ὁ Θεός» ψάλλεται τὸ «Χριστὸς Ἀνέστη.»

Ὁ Ἱερεὺς ραντίζει τὸ νεκρὸν σταυροειδῶς δι' ἐλαίου λέγων·

Ἱερεὺς: Ῥαντιεῖς με ὑσώπῳ καὶ καθαρισθήσομαι, πλυνεῖς με, καὶ ὑπὲρ χιόνα λευκανθήσομαι. (Ψαλ. ν', 7)

Εἶτα ὁ Ἱερεὺς ρίπτει γαίαν σταυροειδῶς ἐπὶ τοῦ νεκροῦ λέγων·

Ἱερεὺς: Τοῦ Κυρίου ἡ γῆ, καὶ τὸ πλήρωμα αὐτῆς, ἡ οἰκουμένη καὶ πάντες οἱ κατοικοῦντες ἐν αὐτῇ. Γῆ ἦν καὶ εἰς γῆν ἀπελεύσει. (Ψαλ. κγ', 1, Γεν. γ', 19)

Ἱερεὺς: Δι' εὐχῶν τῶν ἁγίων πατέρων ἡμῶν, Κύριε, Ἰησοῦ Χριστέ, ὁ Θεός, ἐλέησον καὶ σῶσον ἡμᾶς.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Theotokion.

Now and forever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Same Mode.

Through the prayers of her that gave You birth, O Christ, and the prayers of Your Forerunner, of Apostles, Prophets, Hierarchs, Ascetics, and of the Righteous, and of all the Saints, to Your sleeping servant do You grant repose.

Via tradition, the sprinkling of oil and earth happens at the cemetery during the burial. However, for practical purposes, this takes place in the Church following the final kiss.

After the Dismissal, the Priest, holding the censer and the blessing Cross, escorts the body from the Solea to the Narthex, while the People chant the long "Holy God."

During the Easter period, instead of chanting "Holy God" the People chant "Christ is risen."

Then the Priest sprinkles the deceased in the form of the Cross with oil, saying:

Priest: Sprinkle me with hyssop and I shall be clean. Wash me and I shall be whiter than snow. (Ps. 50:7)

Then the Priest sprinkles the deceased in the form of the Cross with earth, saying:

Priest: The Earth is the Lord's, and the fullness thereof; the world and they that dwell therein. You are earth and to earth you shall return. (Ps. 23:1; Gen. 3:19)

Priest: Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us and save us.

People: Amen.

Εὐχαί Συγχωρητικάί

Ὑπὲρ τοῦ κεκοιμένου εἰς λῦσιν ἐπιτιμίου,
ἀναγινωσκόμεναι ὑπὸ Ἀρχιερέως.

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

Ἀρχιερεύς: Κύριε ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, ὁ τῇ σῇ ἀρρόγητῳ σοφίᾳ δημιουργήσας τὸν ἄνθρωπος ἐκ τοῦ χοῦ, καὶ τοῦτον ἀναμορφώσας εἰς εἶδος καὶ κάλλος, καὶ ἐξωραΐσας, ὡς τίμιον καὶ οὐράνιον κτῆμα, εἰς δοξολογίαν καὶ εὐπρέπειαν τῆς σῆς δόξης καὶ βασιλείας, διὰ τὸ κατ' εἰκόνα καὶ καθ' ὁμοίωσιν τοῦτον παραγαγεῖν· τὴν ἐντολὴν δὲ παραβάντα τοῦ σου προστάγματος, καὶ μεταλαβόντα τῆς εἰκόνος, καὶ μὴ φυλάξαντα· καὶ διὰ τοῦτο, ἵνα μὴ τὸ κακὸν ἀθάνατον γένηται, φιλανθρωπῶς κελεύσας τὴν κρᾶσιν, καὶ μῖξιν ταύτην, καὶ τὸν ἄρρόγητόν σου, τοῦτον δεσμόν, ὡς Θεὸς τῶν Πατέρων ἡμῶν, τῷ θείῳ βουλήματι ἀποτέμενεσθαι καὶ διαλύεσθαι· ὥστε τὴν μὲν ψυχὴν ἐκεῖσε χωρεῖν, ἔνθα καὶ τὸ εἶναι προσελάβετο, μέχρι τῆς κοινῆς ἀναστάσεως, τὸ δὲ σῶμα εἰς τὰ ἐξ ὧν συνετέθη ἀναλύεσθαι· διὰ τοῦτο δεόμεθα σοῦ τοῦ ἀνάρχου Πατρὸς, καὶ τοῦ μονογενοῦς σου Υἱοῦ, καὶ τοῦ παναγίου, καὶ ὁμοουσίου καὶ ζωοποιοῦ σου Πνεύματος, ἵνα μὴ παρίδῃς τὸ σὸν πλάσμα καταποθῆναι τῇ ἀπωλείᾳ· ἀλλὰ τὸ μὲν σῶμα διαλυθῆναι εἰς τὰ ἐξ ὧν συνετέθη, τὴν δὲ ψυχὴν καταταγῆναι ἐν τῷ χορῷ τῶν δικαίων. Ναί, Κύριε ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, νικησάτω σου τὸ ἄμετρον ἔλεος, καὶ ἡ φιλανθρωπία ἡ ἀνείκαστος· καὶ εἴτε ὑπὸ κατάραν πατρὸς ἢ μητρὸς, εἴτε τῷ ἰδίῳ ἀναθέματι ὑπέπεσεν ὁ δοῦλός σου

Prayers For Forgiveness

Of every curse and excommunication
read for the deceased by a Hierarch.

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Hierarch: O Lord our God, in your inexpressible wisdom You created man out of the earth, giving him form and adorning him with beauty, as a precious and heavenly being, to the praise and honor of Your glory and Kingdom, making him in Your Image and Likeness. But when he violated Your commandment and did not preserve the image which had been entrusted to him, so that his evil state should not endure forever, in Your love for mankind You ordered that this mixture and blend, and the unbroken bond that You had established, O God of our Fathers, should by Your will be severed and dissolved; and that the soul should proceed until the general resurrection to the place from where it received its being, and that the body should be dissolved into the elements from which it was made. Therefore, we pray to You the Father Who is without beginning, and to Your only-begotten Son and Your all-holy and consubstantial and life-creating Spirit: Do not forsake Your creature and let it be swallowed up in destruction; but cause the body to dissolve into its constituent elements, and assign the soul to the company of the righteous. Yes, Lord our God, let Your immeasurable mercy and Your incomprehensible love for mankind prevail; and if Your servant has fallen under the curse of father or mother, or

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οὗτος, **(ἡ δούλη σου αὐτῇ)**, εἴτε τινὰ τῶν ἱερωμένων παρεπίκρανε, καὶ παρ' αὐτοῦ δεσμὸν ἄλυτον ἐδέξατο, εἴτε ὑπὸ Ἀρχιερέως βαρυτάτῳ ἀφορισμῷ περιέπεσε, καὶ ἀμελεία καὶ ῥαθυμία χρησάμενος, **(χρησαμένη)**, οὐκ ἔτυχε συγχωρήσεως, συγχώρησον αὐτῷ **(αὐτῇ)** δι' ἐμοῦ τοῦ ἁμαρτωλοῦ καὶ ἀναξίου δούλου σου· καὶ τὸ μὲν σῶμα αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** εἰς τὰ ἐξ ὧν συνετέθη διάλυσον, τὴν δὲ ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** ἐν σκηναῖς Ἁγίων κατὰταξον. Ναί, Κύριε ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, ὁ τοῖς ἁγίοις σου Μαθηταῖς καὶ Ἀποστόλοις τὴν ἐξουσίαν ταύτην δοὺς ὥστε τῶν ἁμαρτημάτων διδόναι τὴν ἄφεσιν, καὶ εἰπών· «Ὅσα ἂν δήσητε καὶ λύσητε, ἵνα ὧσι δεδεμένα,» **(Μθ. ιθ', 18)** καὶ λελυμένα· δι' αὐτῶν δὲ καὶ εἰς ἡμᾶς, εἰ καὶ ἀναξίους, ὡσαύτως τὴν τηλικαύτην δωρεὰν φιλανθρώπως διαβιβάσας, λύσον τὸν κοιμηθέντα δοῦλόν **(τὴν κοιμηθεῖσαν δούλην)** σου **(δεῖνα)** τοῦ ψυχικοῦ καὶ σωματικοῦ ἁμαρτήματος, καὶ ἔστω συγκεχωρημένος, **(συγκεχωρημένη)**, καὶ ἐν τῷ νῦν αἰῶνι καὶ ἐν τῷ μέλλοντι· πρεσβείαις τῆς παναχράντου καὶ ἀειπαρθένου σου Μητρός, καὶ πάντων σου τῶν Ἁγίων.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Εὐχή Ἑτέρα

Διάκονος: Τοῦ Κυρίου δεηθῶμεν.

Λαός: Κύριε, ἐλέησον.

Ἀρχιερεὺς: Δέσποτα πολυέλεε, Κύριε Ἰησοῦ Χριστέ ὁ Θεὸς ἡμῶν, ὁ τὰς κλεῖς τῆς τῶν οὐρανῶν Βασιλείας, καὶ τῇ σῇ χάριτι τὴν τοῦ δεσμεῖν τε καὶ λύειν τὰς τῶν

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under his **(her)** own curse, or if he **(she)** has embittered any of the clergy, and has been subjected by any of them to a bond from which he **(she)** was not released, or has received a heavy ban from any Bishop, and through negligence or laziness did not seek forgiveness, forgive him **(her)** through me Your sinful and unworthy servant; dissolve his **(her)** body into the elements from which it was composed, and assign his **(her)** soul to the dwelling place of the saints. Yes, Lord, our God, Who gave this authority to Your holy Disciples and Apostles to grant remission of sins, saying to them: “Whatever you bind or loose, let it be bound or loosed,” (Mt. 18:18) and who through them, have in Your love transmitted this great Gift to us, even though we are not worthy of it, loose your servant *(name)*, who has fallen asleep, from all sins of soul and body, and let him **(her)** be forgiven within the present age and in the age to come; through the intercession of Your all-pure and ever-virgin Mother and of all Your saints.

People: Amen.

Alternate Prayer

Deacon: Let us pray to the Lord.

People: Lord, have mercy.

Hierarch: Most merciful, Master, Lord Jesus Christ our God, Who, after Your Holy Resurrection from the dead on the third day, granted the keys of the Heavenly Kingdom to

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ἀνθρώπων ἀμαρτίας, μετὰ τὴν ἀγίαν σου ἐκ νεκρῶν
τριήμερον ἐξανάστασιν, τοῖς σοῖς ἀγίοις Μαθηταῖς καὶ
ἱεροῖς Ἀποστόλοις δωρησάμενος ἐξουσίαν, ὥστε δεδεμένα
εἶναι καὶ ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ ὅσα δι' αὐτῶν ἐν γῇ δέδενται, καὶ
λελυμένα ὡσαύτως ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ ὅσα δι' αὐτῶν ἐν γῇ
λέλυνται, διαδόχους δὲ ἡμᾶς τοὺς εὐτελεῖς καὶ ἀναξίους
δούλους σου τῆς αὐτῆς ταύτης παρὰ σοῦ ὑπεραγίας
δωρεᾶς τε καὶ χάριτος τῇ ἀφάτῳ σου φιλανθρωπία
καταξιώσας γενέσθαι, ὥστε καὶ ἡμᾶς οὕτω δεσμεῖν τε καὶ
λύειν τὰ ἐν τῷ λαῷ σου συμβαίνοντα· αὐτός, πανάγαθε
Βασιλεῦ, δι' ἐμοῦ τοῦ ταπεινοῦ καὶ ἀναξίου δούλου σου,
συγχώρησον τῷ δούλῳ **(τῇ δούλῃ)** σου **(τῷ δεῖνι)** εἴτι ἐν
τῷ παρόντι βίω ὡς ἄνθρωπος ἐπλημμέλησε· καὶ ἄφες
αὐτῷ **(αὐτῇ)** ὅσα ἐν λόγῳ ἢ ἔργῳ ἢ κατὰ διάνοιαν ἥμαρτε,
λύσας αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** καὶ τὸν ἐπικείμενον, μεθ'
οἰωνδήποτε τρόπων, δεσμόν, ὃν αὐτὸς καθ' ἑαυτὸν **(αὐτὴ
καθ' ἑαυτήν)** ἐκ συναρπαγῆς ἢ ἄλλης τινὸς αἰτίας
ἔδησεν, εἴτε ὑπὸ Ἀρχιερέως εἴτε παρ' ἄλλου τινός, φθόνῳ
καὶ συνεργείᾳ τοῦ πονηροῦ, τοιοῦτον ὑπέστη ὀλίσθημα·
εὐδόκησον, ὡς μόνος ἀγαθὸς καὶ πολυέλεος, τὴν μὲν
ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ **(αὐτῆς)** μετὰ τῶν Ἀγίων ταχθῆναι τῶν ἀπ'
αἰῶνός σοι εὐαρεστησάντων, τὸ δὲ σῶμα τῇ παρὰ σοῦ
δημιουργηθείσῃ φύσει δοθῆναι. Ὅτι εὐλογητὸς καὶ
δεδοξασμένος ὑπάρχεις εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας.

Λαός: Ἀμήν.

Διὰ τὸ τέλος τῆς Ἀκολουθίας βλ. σελ. 38.

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Your holy Disciples and revered Apostles and, through Your grace, gave them authority to bind and to loose the sins of men, so that all those bound by them on Earth would also be bound in Heaven, and all those loosed by them on Earth would also be loosed in Heaven; Who in Your inexpressible love for mankind made us, Your lowly and unworthy servants, to share as their successors in this same most holy Gift and Grace from You, so that we also might bind or loose the sins of Your people; do You Yourself, all good King, forgive Your servant *(name)*, through me Your humble and unworthy servant, from whatever transgressions he **(she)** committed in this life because of human weakness. Pardon him **(her)** all his **(her)** sins in word or deed or thought; free him **(her)** from every bond that rests upon him **(her)**, whatever it may be, whether from self-delusion or for any other reason he **(she)** bound himself **(herself)**, or was bound by a Bishop or any other person, and so fell into this grievous state through the envy and incitement of the Evil One. Since You alone are good and merciful, grant that his **(her)** soul may join the company of the saints who have pleased You through the ages, and that his **(her)** body may be given back to the nature which was created by You. For You are blessed and glorified to the ages.

People: Amen.

For the conclusion of the service turn back to page 39.